

Word family: **generic / generically / genericness / generics**

Base word: generic

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, also **noun**

Related forms:

* **generic** (adj.) — 普通的；非特定品牌的；概括性的；通用的

* **generically** (adv.) — 一般地；以通用方式

* **genericness** (n., uncommon) — 普通、缺乏特色的性質

* **generic** (n.) — 非品牌藥 / 仿製藥；通用版本

* **generics** (plural noun) — 非品牌產品；仿製藥

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **generic present**

* **generic product**

* **generic brand**

* **generic name**

* **generic term**

* **generic drug**

* **generic version**

* **generic software / component**

* **generic design**

* **generic answer**

* **generic advice**

* **generic message**

* **generic character**

* **generic programming**

Meaning in this passage

> In the future, I think I will try to give fewer **generic** presents and more meaningful ones...

Here, **generic** means:

ordinary and not specially chosen or personalized for the individual — 普通制式的；缺乏個人特色的；千篇一律的

The speaker means gifts that could be given to almost anyone without much thought about that person's individual tastes or memories.

中文翻譯：

將來，我想我會盡量少送一些太**制式化 / 千篇一律**的禮物，多送一些更有意義的東西。

So here:

generic present = 不太針對收禮者本人、缺乏個人特色和心思的常規禮物

1. **generic (普通制式的；缺乏特色的) — 制式化的；千篇一律的**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I want to give fewer **generic presents** in the future.

將來我想少送一些**太制式化的禮物**。

Practice 2

> The message sounded too **generic**.

那段訊息聽起來太**公式化 / 缺乏個人特色**。

Practice 3

> The design is clean but a little **generic**.

這個設計很整潔，但有點**普通、缺乏特色**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic = lacking distinctive, personal, or specific features; suitable for many people or situations****

中文：

****缺乏獨特、個人化或具體特色，因此適用於很多不同對象或情況的****

2. **generic gift / present — 制式化禮物；大路禮物**

Practice 1

> A gift card can feel like a **generic gift** if no thought goes into it.

如果沒有花心思，禮品卡可能會令人覺得是一份**很制式化的禮物**。

Practice 2

> She wanted something more personal than a **generic present**.

她想送一份比普通**大路禮物**更有個人心意的東西。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic gift = 不太針對特定收禮者而選、任何人都可以收到的常規禮物

3. **generic answer — 籠統答案；公式化答案**

Practice 1

> His answer was too **generic**.

他的答案太**籠統**。

Practice 2

> Try to avoid **generic answers** in an interview.

面試時盡量避免給出**公式化答案**。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic answer = 不夠具體、可以套用到很多情況的答案

4. **generic advice — 籠統建議；大路建議**

Practice 1

> The article gives very **generic advice**.

這篇文章提供的建議非常**籠統**。

Practice 2

> I need specific help, not **generic advice**.

我需要具體幫助，而不是**大路建議**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic advice = 沒有針對個別情況作出調整的普遍性建議****

5. ****generic message — 公式化訊息；罐頭訊息****

Practice 1

> The email felt like a ****generic message**** sent to everyone.

那封電郵像是一段發給所有人的****罐頭訊息****。

Practice 2

> A personal note feels warmer than a ****generic message****.

私人留言比****公式化訊息****更有人情味。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic message = 可以原封不動傳給很多人的非個人化訊息****

6. ****generic design / style — 普通、缺乏辨識度的設計 / 風格****

Practice 1

> The hotel has a rather ****generic design****.

這間酒店的設計相當****普通，缺乏辨識度****。

Practice 2

> The logo looks too ****generic****.

這個標誌看起來太****大路 / 沒有特色****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic design/style = 沒有明顯獨特特徵，看起來跟很多同類事物相似的設計或風格****

7. ****generic (一般性的；非特定的) — 一般的；通用的****

A more neutral sense.

Practice 1

> We need a **generic term** that covers all these products.

我們需要一個可以涵蓋這些產品的**通用名稱**。

Practice 2

> The software uses a **generic interface**.

這個軟件使用一個**通用介面**。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic = relating to a whole class or type rather than one specific example

中文：

指向整個類別，而不是某一個具體個體的

8. **generic term — 通用名稱；一般術語**

Practice 1

> “Vehicle” is a **generic term** for cars, buses, and trucks.

Vehicle 是汽車、巴士和貨車的**統稱**。

Practice 2

> We need a **generic term** for all these devices.

我們需要一個涵蓋這些裝置的**通用術語**。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic term = 用來指一整類事物，而非某個特定品牌或個體的詞

9. **generic name — 通用名稱；非品牌名稱**

Practice 1

> Paracetamol is a **generic name**, while brands may use different product names.

Paracetamol 是**通用藥名**，不同品牌可能使用不同商品名稱。

Practice 2

> The form asks for the **generic name** of the substance.

表格要求填寫該物質的**通用名稱**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic name = 某類產品、物質或藥物的正式一般名稱，而不是品牌名稱****

10. **generic product — 非品牌產品；普通產品**

Practice 1

> The supermarket sells cheaper **generic products**.

超級市場出售較便宜的**非品牌產品**。

Practice 2

> Some consumers prefer **generic products** to branded ones.

部分消費者較喜歡**非品牌商品**而不是品牌產品。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic product = 以產品類別而非強勢品牌身份出售的商品****

11. **generic brand — 自家牌 / 非主要品牌**

Usage can vary by market.

Practice 1

> The store offers a cheaper **generic brand**.

這間店有較便宜的**自家牌 / 非主要品牌**選擇。

Practice 2

> She chose the **generic brand** instead of the famous one.

她選了**普通品牌**，而不是知名品牌。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic brand = 沒有強勢品牌定位、通常較便宜的產品品牌或零售自家牌

12. **generic drug / generic medicine — 仿製藥；非專利品牌藥**

A major distinct noun/adjective sense.

Practice 1

> The doctor said a **generic drug** would work just as well.

醫生說**仿製藥**也可以有同樣效果。

Practice 2

> **Generic medicines** are often cheaper than brand-name versions.

仿製藥通常比品牌藥便宜。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic drug = 與品牌原研藥含有相同活性成分、在專利等條件允許後以非原品牌出售的藥物

13. **a generic (仿製藥) — 一種仿製藥**

Noun use.

Practice 1

> The pharmacist offered me a cheaper **generic**.

藥劑師提供了一款較便宜的**仿製藥**。

Practice 2

> Many common medicines are available as **generics**.

很多常用藥都有**仿製藥版本**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****a generic = a non-brand-name version of a medicine or, less commonly, another product****

14. ****generic version — 通用版；非品牌版本****

Practice 1

> There's a cheaper ****generic version**** of the product.

這產品有一個較便宜的****通用 / 非品牌版本****。

Practice 2

> The company released a ****generic version**** for broader use.

公司推出了一個供更廣泛用途使用的****通用版本****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic version = 不屬於特定品牌、客戶或個別用途的標準版本****

15. ****generic software / solution — 通用軟件 / 通用方案****

Practice 1

> The company chose a ****generic software solution****.

公司選擇了一套****通用軟件方案****。

Practice 2

> A ****generic solution**** may not fit every customer's needs.

****通用方案**未必能符合每位客戶的需要。**

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****generic solution = 為廣泛使用情況設計，而不是度身訂造的標準方案****

16. ****generic character / plot — 公式化角色 / 劇情****

Practice 1

> The film has several **generic characters**.

這部電影有幾個很**公式化、缺乏特色的角色**。

Practice 2

> The plot felt predictable and **generic**.

劇情感覺既可預料又**很公式化**。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic character/plot = 沒有鮮明個性，像很多同類作品中的標準模板

17. **generically** — 一般地；以通用方式

Practice 1

> The product is **generically** described as a cleaning agent.

這種產品被**概括地**描述為清潔劑。

Practice 2

> The template is designed **generically** so that different teams can use it.

這個模板以**通用方式**設計，讓不同團隊都可以使用。

MCQ-ready definition:

generically = in a general, non-specific, or non-branded way

18. **generic programming** — 泛型程式設計

A technical computing sense.

Practice 1

> The course introduces **generic programming**.

這個課程介紹**泛型程式設計**。

Practice 2

> **Generic programming** allows code to work with different data types.

泛型程式設計讓程式碼可以配合不同資料類型使用。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic programming = programming that uses general type patterns so the same code can work with multiple data types

中文：

利用一般化型別設計，使同一套程式碼可處理多種資料類型的程式設計方式

19. **generic type / generic class — 泛型類型 / 泛型類別**

Practice 1

> The function accepts a **generic type**.

這個函數接受**泛型類型**。

Practice 2

> The library provides several **generic classes**.

這個程式庫提供多個**泛型類別**。

MCQ-ready definition:

generic type/class = computing: a type or class written to work with different data types

Important distinction 1: **generic vs general**

These are related but not identical.

general

broad; not detailed or limited.

generic

not specific to one individual/type/brand and often standardized.

> general advice

一般性建議

> generic advice

可以套用到很多人、缺乏個人化的建議

Generic can carry a stronger “template-like” feeling.

Important distinction 2: **generic** vs **ordinary**

ordinary

not unusual or special.

generic

lacks distinctive or individual features.

> an ordinary bag

普通袋

> a generic design

缺乏特色、像模板的設計

Something may be ordinary without feeling generic.

Important distinction 3: **generic** vs **standard**

standard

follows an accepted norm/specification.

generic

not tailored to a specific brand/person/use.

> standard size

標準尺寸

> generic solution

通用方案

A standard product can still be branded and distinctive.

Important distinction 4: **generic vs basic**

basic

simple, essential, or without advanced features.

generic

non-specific or lacking distinctive identity.

> basic phone

功能基本的手機

> generic phone design

缺乏特色的手機設計

Important distinction 5: **generic vs bland**

generic

lacks distinctiveness.

bland

lacks strong flavour, character, or excitement.

A design can be both, but **bland** is more strongly evaluative.

Important distinction 6: **generic vs personalized**

This is the key contrast in your passage.

generic

could suit almost anyone.

personalized

specially adapted to one person.

> a generic gift card

較制式的禮物

> a personalized photo album

專為某人製作的相簿

Important distinction 7: **generic vs personal**

generic

impersonal and broadly applicable.

personal

connected specifically with one person's memories, feelings, needs, or identity.

This mirrors the central contrast of your entire passage.

Important distinction 8: **generic product vs unbranded product**

generic product

may be sold without a strong proprietary brand identity.

unbranded product

specifically has no visible/recognized brand.

They overlap, but **generic** can also mean a store-label or standard alternative rather than literally brandless.

Important distinction 9: **generic drug vs counterfeit drug**

Very important.

generic drug

legitimate medicine using the same active ingredient as a reference brand drug.

counterfeit drug

illegally/fraudulently imitates another product.

A generic is not a fake.

Important distinction 10: **generic name vs brand name**

generic name

official/common substance or product name.

brand name

commercial name chosen by a company.

This distinction is especially important in medicine.

Important distinction 11: **generic = neutral vs generic = negative**

The word can be neutral:

> generic term

> = 通用名稱

But it can also be mildly negative:

> generic movie

> = 公式化、沒有特色的電影

In your passage, the tone is mildly negative: the gifts are acceptable but lacking personal thought.

Important distinction 12: **generic answer vs vague answer**

generic answer

broad/template-like and not tailored.

vague answer

unclear or lacking precision.

A generic answer can be perfectly clear but still not specific to the situation.

Important distinction 13: **generic vs cliché**

generic

lacks unique features.

cliché

overused idea/expression.

A generic gift may not be a cliché; a cliché is specifically something worn out through repetition.

Family-extension note

Generic has four strong modern branches:

1. **non-personalized / lacking distinctiveness**

- * generic gift
- * generic message
- * generic design
- * generic character

2. **general category rather than specific example**

- * generic term
- * generic name
- * generic solution

3. **non-brand / standard commercial version**

* generic product

* generic version

4. **medicine**

* generic drug

* a generic

And a technical extension:

5. **computing**

* generic programming

* generic type

For your passage, the exact branch is:

generic = broadly suitable but not specifically chosen for the individual

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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generic (gift/design)	制式化的；缺乏特色的	non-personalized	
generic present	大路 / 制式化禮物	could suit anyone	
generic answer	籠統 / 公式化答案	not tailored	
generic advice	一般化建議	broadly applicable	
generic message	罐頭 / 公式化訊息	impersonal	
generic design	缺乏辨識度的設計	template-like	
generic (general)	通用的；一般性的	class-level	
generic term	通用名稱 / 統稱	category word	
generic name	通用名稱	non-brand name	
generic product	非品牌 / 普通產品	standard commercial version	
generic brand	自家牌 / 普通品牌	low-distinctiveness brand	
generic drug	仿製藥	non-brand medicine	
a generic	一種仿製藥	noun use	
generic version	通用版	standard version	
generic solution	通用方案	not customized	
generic character	公式化角色	lacks individuality	
generically	一般地；通用地	non-specific manner	
generic programming	泛型程式設計	multi-type code	

| ****generic type**** | 泛型類型 | general type parameter |

For your original sentence

> In the future, I think I will try to give fewer ****generic presents**** and more meaningful ones...

Here:

****generic presents = 那種任何人都可以收到、比較大路、缺乏個人心思和針對性的禮物****

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 將來，我想我會盡量少送一些太****制式化 / 大路****的禮物，多送一些更有意義的東西。

The contrast is:

> ****generic**** → anyone could receive it

> ****personal / meaningful**** → chosen or created specifically because of who that person is

For this passage, ****「制式化」**** is probably the cleanest formal translation, while ****「大路」**** captures the natural Hong Kong conversational nuance very nicely.